VAUGHN XAVIER HAYNES

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EDUCATION

Master of Library & Information Science, Wayne State University | *Detroit, MI* | *December 2026*

Bachelor of Arts in English; Bachelor of Fine Arts in Theatre, Michigan State University | *East Lansing, MI* | *May 2022*

English concentration in Creative Writing; Theatre focus in acting and directing; Honors College; Dean's List.

EMPLOYMENT

Adult Services Librarian, Springfield Township Library | *Davisburg, MI* | *July 2025 - Present*

- Provide reference services to patrons of all ages.
- Plan, promote, and facilitate adult and family programs, collaborating with public librarians across Michigan for programming ideas.
- Manage the adult collection in response to patron interests and community needs.
- Completed a WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility audit of the library website, revised its content and structure to reduce redundancy and improve navigation.

Graduate Student Assistant, Wayne State University Library System | *Detroit, MI* | *Jan. 2025 - Present*

- Deliver online chat reference and research support to students, faculty, and alumni using Springshare LibAnswers, greater Michigan residents using Research Help Now; provide circulation services in Sierra.
- Lead and assist library instruction in undergraduate and graduate courses; co-design and lead workshops addressing technology and intersectionality.
- Lead independent digital and public-engagement projects from research/design to implementation and documentation, create accessible research guides, exhibits, and interactive data visualizations.

Student Assistant, Walter P. Reuther Labor Archives, Wayne State University Library System | *Detroit, MI* | *Aug. 2024 - Dec. 2024*

- Retrieved archival materials for researchers, maintain location records and careful handling throughout use.
- Supported researchers and daily reading-room operations through responsive front-desk service and clerical work.

Customer Service Representative, Sherwood Forest Branch, Detroit Public Library | *Detroit, MI* | *Aug. 2024 - Dec. 2024*

- Delivered circulation and patron-account services using SirsiDynix WorkFlows, operated register, updating records, and resolving routine account questions.
- Completed paging and shelving workflows to keep materials organized and readily accessible.

Library Branch Assistant, Children's Library, St. Clair County Library System | *Port Huron, MI* | *Aug. 2022 - Nov. 2022*

- Provided circulation, account, and introductory reference services for children, caregivers, and other patrons using SirsiDynix Horizon.
- Coordinated and processed local, systemwide, and MeLCat requests, expanding access to materials beyond the branch collection.
- Conducted outreach at local schools to promote library-card registration and connect students and families with children's library services.

Teaching Assistant, THR 341: Beginning Play Directing, MSU Department of Theatre | *East Lansing, MI* | *Jan. 2022 - May 2022*

- Collaborated with the instructor to prepare lessons and support instruction in directing theory and play analysis.
- Led discussions and project critiques, providing specific, actionable feedback that helped students clarify artistic choices and strengthen their directing practice.
- Cultivated an inclusive learning environment that encouraged experimentation, discussion, and constructive peer feedback.

Writing Consultant, MSU Writing Center | *East Lansing, MI | Sept. 2021 - May 2022*

- Conducted one-on-one consultations with writers from first-year undergraduates through doctoral candidates, supporting projects from early planning through final revision.
- Tailored feedback to each writer's goals, audience, assignment, and disciplinary conventions while reinforcing the writer's ownership of the work.
- Helped writers develop transferable strategies for interpreting assignments, organizing ideas, and revising independently.

SCHOLARSHIP

Publications

Haynes, V. X. (2026). Reading Disrepair: Library Space and Institutional Value. *Humanities Methods in Librarianship*. https://docs.humanitiesmethods.org/1/reading-disrepair

Haynes, V. X. (2026). Francis Miksa Jr. (1938-2019). *American Library Association.* hdl:11213/23965.2

Articles Under Review

Haynes, V. X. (2027). From Storytime to Search Strategy: Children's Library Skills for Academic Instruction. In R. L. Sittler, T. Rogerson, & T. Otto (Eds.), *The New Library Instruction Cookbook*. Association of College & Research Libraries.

Haynes, V. X. (2027). Mourning the Mission: Institutional Grief in Academic Librarianship. In *Rooted in Community: The proceedings of the ACRL 2027 Conference*.

Haynes, V. X. (2027). Parmesan with your Spaghetti Code? What New Digital Librarians Inherit. *Journal of Critical Digital Librarianship*.

Presentations

Haynes, V. X. (2027, April 8). *Mourning the Mission: Institutional Grief in Academic Librarianship* [Paper presentation]. Association of College and Research Libraries 2027 Conference, Portland, OR, United States.

Haynes, V. X. (2026, December 3). *The Research Tutorial Should Teach Recovery, Not Perfection* [Lightning talk]. 2026 eLearning in Libraries Symposium.

Haynes, V. X. (2026, October 29). *Resilience Infrastructure: Aggressive Advocacy Strategy for Rural Libraries* [Conference presentation]. Michigan Library Association 2026 Annual Conference, Novi, MI, United States.

Haynes, V. X. (2026, July 17). *Don't Fight the Friction: Harnessing Literacy Speedbumps as an Instructional Tool* [Conference presentation]. Michigan Instruction Exchange (MIX) Conference 2026, Alma, MI, United States.

Haynes, V. X., & Hovey, T. (2026, May 7). *MeL Map: 20 Years of Connections Between Wayne State and Michigan Libraries* [Conference presentation]. MiALA Annual Conference 2026, Traverse City, MI, United States.

Haynes, V. X. (2026, May 7). *One Question, Three Perspectives: Views on AI Among LIS Students, Faculty, and Librarians* [Poster session]. MiALA Annual Conference 2026, Traverse City, MI, United States.

Haynes, V. X. (2026, April 2). *From Compliance to Equity: Overhauling the Wayne State University Library System Accessibility Statement* [Conference presentation]. Beyond Barriers Conference 2026: Centering Social Justice in L/IS, Detroit, MI, United States.

Haynes, V. X., & McGowan, M. M. (2026, February 9). *Algorithms and Injustice: Let's Imagine a Different Future* [Workshop presentation]. Wayne State University, Detroit, MI, United States.

CERTIFICATIONS

Digitization Basics Pathway, Library of Michigan | *July 2026*
Teaching Information Literacy Certificate, the Ohio State University | *July 2026*
AI Literacy Essentials for Academic Libraries, Clarivate | *July 2026*
Social & Behavioral Researchers, CITI Program | *Oct. 2025* | 72957532
MeL Maven Badge, Michigan eLibrary | *Jan. 2025*

SELECTED PROJECTS

Public Programming | Coordinated and facilitated programming for adults at a public library; collaborated with public librarians across Michigan to find and corroborate quality programs.

Library Instruction | Assisted library instruction sessions for ENG 1020: Introductory College Writing, ENG 3010: Intermediate Writing, PH 5150: Public Health Practicum, HE 1010: Foundations of Health and Health Promotion, Speech-Language Pathology Grad Students, Doctor of Audiology grad students.

LibGuide Development and Maintenance | Created and maintained several LibGuides, including subject of the month guides on Queer Anticapitalism and Doors, topical guides on Digital Poverty *(winner of the 2026 SIS Student Writing Award)*, WSU's College to Career initiative, the Safiya Noble event, the WSU Accessibility Statement, a reading list for Latina/o and Latin American Studies, internal exhibit creation documentation, and the MeL Map; updated dead links, improved accessibility, added proxy links, and corrected content issues across several other subject guides.

Algorithms and Injustice Workshop | Co-designed, developed, and led a workshop on themes from Safiya Noble's *Algorithms of Oppression*, including search engines, AI, privacy, discrimination, and injustice.

Collection Development Policy | Assessed and revised the WSU collection development policy using ACRL and ALA guidance, affiliate university policies, and growing and emerging trends in academic libraries.

Detroit Music Exhibit | Researched, designed, and installed a large 10-panel atrium exhibit on the evolution of Detroit's music scene for Black History Month.

Safiya Noble Event Support | Designed and implemented onsite programming and engagement for a scholar/author visit, researched and created a LibGuide, and helped coordinate event logistics.

Dolly Parton Imagination Reading Event | Helped coordinate, set up, and run a reading event with community partners, including a senior assisted living facility, university library, and elementary school.

Accessibility Audit: < 50,000 | Audited the website of the Springfield Township Library, adjusted and followed guidelines to bring the page up to WCAG 2.1 AA Compliance; eliminated redundancies and merged content to improve site structure.

Accessibility Audit: > 50,000 | Assisted overhauling the WSU Library System accessibility statement; cross-referenced partner university accessibility statements, examined Title II compliance, outlined the new guide hosting the statement, and evaluated vendor/publisher accessibility statements. Work selected for presentation at the 2026 SIS Beyond Barriers Conference.

MeL Map | Designed an interactive map based on WSU's history of MeLCat using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JSON, Mapbox, and Deck.gl; expanded project to include all libraries in Michigan; created an accompanying LibGuide with statistics, analysis, IMLS funding context, and custom widgets utilizing Chart.js. Work selected for presentation at the 2026 Michigan Academic Library Association Conference.

Display Cases | Researched, designed, installed, and later coordinated multiple special-collections-based displays, including displays on the Hezy Shoshani Collection, Detroit art and culture, anatomy and medical history, Arab-American heritage, faculty publications, solidarity, and the Detroit Poetry Collection.

Incarcerated Students Reference Project | Provided reference assistance for incarcerated undergraduate students in the WSU Prison Education Program at Macomb Correctional Facility and helped coordinate requests.

Georeferencing / Atlascope Detroit | Contributed georeferencing to the Detroit branch of Atlascope, a historical Sanborn fire insurance map overlay project; provided quality control and took lead after the departure of the previous project lead.

Library Website Migration Research | Collected data on peer, partner, and model academic university websites to support direction-setting for a new library website.

Digital Collections and Accessible Technology | Maintained backend HTML for an OCLC-hosted CONTENTdm digital collection and updated the library system's accessible technology inventory by testing equipment and documenting working technology.

Film Screening: 1984 | Designed and implemented programming for a film screening of 1984.

HONORS & AWARDS

SIS Student Writing Award, Wayne State University School of Information Science | *Oct. 2026*

MLA Conference Scholarship, Michigan Library Association | *Sept. 2026*
ACRL Member of the Week, Association of College & Research Libraries | *Aug. 2026*
MiALA Conference Scholarship, Michigan Academic Library Association | *Mar. 2026*
MiALA Member Spotlight, Michigan Academic Library Association | *Dec. 2025*
Graduate Student Assistantship, Wayne State University Libraries | *Jan. 2025*
Frank C. Rutledge Endowed Scholarship in Theatre, MSU College of Arts & Letters | *Sept. 2021*
Young Composers of Michigan Finalist, Michigan Music Education Association | *Dec. 2017*
Young Composers of Michigan Finalist, Michigan Music Education Association | *Dec. 2016*

ORGANIZATIONS

SERVICE

Membership Committee, Michigan Academic Library Association | *July 2026 - July 2027*
Oversee assessment of value of added services for individual and institutional members.
Advise the board on various matters pertaining to membership.
Answer membership questions and follow up with non-renewing members.

Book and Author Society Committee, The Library Network | *Jan. 2026 - Oct. 2026*
Helped plan an author speaking event for TLN featuring author Marjen Kamali.
Also a member of the Collection Grant Subcommittee: decided which applicant library received a $1000 starter grant to create or start a physical or digital circulating collection.

President, American Library Association - WSU Student Chapter | *Dec. 2024 - Present*
Recruited presenters for career-oriented programming on medical librarianship, technology in libraries, inclusive youth books, archivist roles, DEI in libraries, information literacy and teaching, archiving rare books, digitization in archives and special collections, and sensory-friendly library spaces.
Created new executive positions for students, including Editor, Librarian Liaison, Research Facilitator, and Book Club Moderator.
Created a showcase for School of Information Science student work.
Coordinated a student session with ALA Past President Cindy Hohl.
Advised other ALA student chapters on organizational growth and collaboration.

Secretary, American Library Association - WSU Student Chapter | *Aug. 2024 - Dec. 2024*

AFFILIATION

Individual Affiliate, International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions | *May 2026 - Present*
Academic and Research Libraries Section.
Information Literacy Section.

Member, Michigan Academic Library Association | *Nov. 2025 - Present*
Mentee, MiALA mentorship program, Feb. 2026 - 2027.
Critical Librarianship Interest Group.
Early Career Library Professionals.
Fine Arts Interest Group.
Higher Education for Incarcerated Students.
Instruction and Information Literacy Interest Group.
Librarian Scholarly and Creative Activity Interest Group.
Mid-Level Leadership Interest Group.

Member, Michigan Library Association | *Sept. 2024 - Present*
Mentee, MLA mentorship program, Oct. 2025 - 2026.

Member, American Library Association | *Sept. 2024 - Present*
Mentee, CLS mentorship program, Aug. 2026 - 2027.
Association of College and Research Libraries

ACRL Arts Section
ACRL College Libraries Section
ACRL Instruction Section
Mentee, Instruction Section Mentoring Program, Nov. 2026 - June 2027
ACRL Literatures in English Section
Reference and User Services Association
Library Instruction Round Table
Library Research Round Table
Mentee, LRRT Mentoring Program, Oct. 2026 - June 2027.

Member, Future Librarians for Inclusivity and Diversity | *Aug. 2024 - Present*

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Attendant, Olympia Park, Chicago Park District | *Chicago, IL* | *Sept. 2023 - Aug. 2024*
Coordinated and indexed information for 150+ families in classes and summer camp.
Stayed current with programming information and relayed details to visitors.
Assisted coworkers with technology needs.

Interim Technical Director, McMorran Place Sports & Entertainment Center | *Port Huron, MI* | *Nov. 2022 - May 2023*
Oversaw inventory, use, and maintenance of multi-thousand-dollar theatrical lighting, sound, and video systems.
Collaborated with producers and directors to realize performance visions.
Coordinated load-in and strike for travelling shows and concerts, oversaw payroll, and adhered to IATSE protocols.

Technician/Operations - Theater, McMorran Place Sports & Entertainment Center | *Port Huron, MI* | *Dec. 2017 - Nov. 2022*
Served as in-house lighting and sound designer for community productions.
Operated lights, sound, and video for concerts and shows with audiences of 1,200 or more.
Ensured safety while loading and setting up set pieces, lights, speakers, and instruments.

Associate Director, MSU Summer Circle Theatre | *East Lansing, MI* | *Jan. 2022 - Aug. 2022*
Directed a company of actors in rehearsal to support a consistent, compelling story.
Collaborated with costume, scenery, sound, and lighting designers to create engaging outdoor performance environments.
Assisted administration and management by logging hours, communicating with sponsors, and generating rehearsal reports.

Ranger, Lakeside Beach & Park and Lighthouse Beach, City of Port Huron | *Port Huron, MI* | *Summers 2020 - 2023*
Maintained cleanliness of park and beach facilities during the COVID-19 pandemic.
Collaborated with local police to enforce ordinances with the public.

Independent Video Game Developer | *Ongoing*
Developing a successfully crowdfunded video game with artists for hire; Kickstarter raised approximately $6,500.
Design game systems, write code, compose soundtrack, write story, and draw 2D pixel art using GameMaker Studio 2, Ableton Live, and MS Paint.
Manage social media presence, create advertisements, and maintain contact with journalists using Twitter, Tumblr, YouTube, Bluesky, and other promotional platforms.
Built website utilizing HTML, CSS, & Javascript and adhered to WCAG accessibility principles.

Musical Artist | *Ongoing*
Compose, arrange, perform, record, mix, and produce original music available on Spotify, Apple Music, and other streaming platforms.

Private Music Instructor | *Ongoing*
Teach percussion, piano, and composition to students of various ages and skill levels.

Transcribe music by ear for students to learn and perform.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

ILS | CARL; Sierra; Workflows; Polaris; Horizon.

Instruction and outreach | In-person, phone, email, and online chat reference; library instruction; public programming; workshop design; event coordination; school outreach; community partnerships.

Digital projects | Webdev (HTML, CSS, JavaScript); web accessibility guidelines; Ploud; LibGuides; CONTENTdm; georeferencing; custom web widgets.

Collections and exhibits | Collection maintenance; exhibit research, design, installation, and documentation; special collections displays.

Creative tools | Video game design; music theory and production; social media promotion; 2D pixel art; basic 3d modeling, texturing, and animation/rigging.

Writing and communication | Fundraising; academic writing/research; editing; research guides; public-facing documentation; program promotion; report writing.